

Practice Paper 7

English

Read the following carefully:

1. **Do not open or turn over the page in this booklet until you are told to do so.**
 2. You have to read a passage and then answer some questions about it. You can look back at the passage to check your answers as many times as you want. There are also some grammar, spelling and punctuation exercises to do.
 3. This is a multiple-choice test in which you have to mark your answer to each question on the answer sheet. You should mark only one answer for each question.
 4. Draw a firm line clearly through the rectangle next to your answer like this . If you make a mistake, rub it out as completely as you can and put in your new answer.
 5. Be sure to keep your place on the answer sheet. Mark your answer in the box that has the same number as the question.
 6. You may not be able to finish all the questions, but try to do as many as you can. If you cannot do a question, do not waste time on it but go on to the next. If you are not sure of an answer, choose the one you think is best.
 7. You may do any rough working on a separate sheet of paper.
 8. **Work as quickly and as carefully as you can.**
 9. You will have 45 minutes to do the test.
-

Read this passage carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

Extract from 'Rikki-Tikki-Tavi' from *The Jungle Book* by Rudyard Kipling

1. This is the story of the great war that Rikki-tikki-tavi fought single-handed, through the bath-rooms of the big bungalow in Segowlee cantonment. Darzee, the Tailorbird, helped him, and Chuchundra, the musk-rat, who never comes out into the middle of the floor, but always creeps round by the wall, gave him advice, but Rikki-tikki did the real fighting.
5. He was a mongoose, rather like a little cat in his fur and his tail, but quite like a weasel in his head and his habits. His eyes and the end of his restless nose were pink. He could scratch himself anywhere he pleased with any leg, front or back, that he chose to use. He could fluff up his tail till it looked like a bottle brush, and his war cry as he scuttled through the long grass was: 'Rikk-tikk-tikki-tikki-tchk!'
10. One day, a high summer flood washed him out of the burrow where he lived with his father and mother, and carried him, kicking and clucking, down a roadside ditch. He found a little wisp of grass floating there, and clung to it till he lost his senses. When he revived, he was lying in the hot sun on the middle of a garden path, very draggled indeed, and a small boy was saying, 'Here's a dead mongoose. Let's have a funeral.'
15. 'No,' said his mother, 'let's take him in and dry him. Perhaps he isn't really dead.'

They took him into the house, and a big man picked him up between his finger and thumb and said he was not dead but half choked. So they wrapped him in cotton wool, and warmed him over a little fire, and he opened his eyes and sneezed.

20. 'Now,' said the big man (he was an Englishman who had just moved into the bungalow), 'don't frighten him, and we'll see what he'll do.'

- It is the hardest thing in the world to frighten a mongoose, because he is eaten up from nose to tail with curiosity. The motto of all the mongoose family is 'Run and find out,' and Rikki-tikki was a true mongoose. He looked at the cotton wool, decided that it was not good to eat, ran all round the table, sat up and put his fur in order, scratched himself,
25. and jumped on the small boy's shoulder.

'Don't be frightened, Teddy,' said his father. 'That's his way of making friends.'

'Ouch! He's tickling under my chin,' said Teddy.

Rikki-tikki looked down between the boy's collar and neck, snuffed at his ear, and climbed down to the floor, where he sat rubbing his nose.

30. 'Good gracious,' said Teddy's mother, 'and that's a wild creature! I suppose he's so tame because we've been kind to him.'

'All mongooses are like that,' said her husband. 'If Teddy doesn't pick him up by the tail, or try to put him in a cage, he'll run in and out of the house all day long. Let's give him something to eat.'

35. They gave him a little piece of raw meat. Rikki-tikki liked it immensely, and when it was finished he went out into the veranda and sat in the sunshine and fluffed up his fur to make it dry to the roots. Then he felt better.

'There are more things to find out about in this house,' he said to himself, 'than all my family could find out in all their lives. I shall certainly stay and find out.'

40. He spent all that day roaming over the house. He nearly drowned himself in the bath-tubs, put his nose into the ink on a writing table, and burned it on the end of the big man's cigar, for he climbed up in the big man's lap to see how writing was done. At nightfall he ran into Teddy's nursery to watch how kerosene lamps were lighted, and when Teddy went to bed Rikki-tikki climbed up too. But he was a restless companion, because he had to
45. get up to attend to every noise all through the night, and find out what made it. Teddy's mother and father came in, the last thing, to look at their boy, and Rikki-tikki was awake on the pillow. 'I don't like that,' said Teddy's mother. 'He may bite the child.' 'He'll do no such thing,' said the father. 'Teddy's safer with that little beast than if he had a bloodhound to watch him. If a snake came into the nursery now...'

50. But Teddy's mother wouldn't think of anything so awful.

Please answer these questions. (Look at the passage again if you need to.)

You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

1

How did the musk-rat help Rikki-tikki?

- A He stayed by the wall.
- B He fought alongside Rikki-tikki.
- C He advised Rikki-tikki.
- D He stood in the middle of the floor.
- E He showed Rikki-tikki how to hide.

2

Where did Rikki-tikki's war take place?

- A Chuchundra
- B Darzee
- C Tavi
- D Tailorbird
- E Segowlee

3

'He was a mongoose, rather like a little cat in his fur and his tail, but quite like a weasel in his head and his habits.' (lines 5–6)

In this sentence, there are two examples of:

- A metaphor
- B simile
- C alliteration
- D personification
- E repetition

4

'He could scratch himself anywhere he pleased with any leg, front or back, that he chose to use.' (lines 6–7)

What does the author want us to understand about Rikki-tikki?

- A He was very flexible.
- B He had fleas.
- C He could scratch himself anywhere in the house.
- D He had lots of legs.
- E His head was in the middle of his body.

5

"Here's a dead mongoose. Let's have a funeral." (line 14)

Why did the boy think the mongoose was dead?

- A He was clinging to a piece of grass.
- B He was kicking and clucking.
- C He looked drowned.
- D His parents were not there.
- E He was far from home.

6

Which of the following best describes the attitude of the family towards Rikki-tikki immediately after finding him?

- A kind
- B scared
- C amused
- D sad
- E uncaring

7

Why did the big man say not to frighten Rikki-tikki?

- A so that Teddy would not get bitten
- B because they had rescued him
- C in case he found a snake
- D so that the family could watch the mongoose
- E because it is hard to frighten a mongoose

8

“It is the hardest thing in the world to frighten a mongoose, because he is eaten up from nose to tail with curiosity.” (lines 21–22)

What does this tell us about mongooses?

- A They chase their tails.
- B They are extremely curious.
- C They are always distracted.
- D They are extremely cautious.
- E They are always anxious.

9

“Good gracious,” said Teddy’s mother, “and that’s a wild creature! I suppose he’s so tame because we’ve been kind to him.” (lines 30–31)

What was Teddy’s mother so surprised about?

- A that a mongoose should be in the house
- B that Teddy was not afraid of the mongoose
- C that a wild animal should be so kind
- D that a wild animal should be so friendly with humans
- E that the mongoose was alive

10

“If Teddy doesn’t pick him up by the tail, or try to put him in a cage, he’ll run in and out of the house all day long.” (lines 32–33)

What does Teddy’s father mean by this?

- A If they put the mongoose in a cage it won’t be able to leave.
- B If Teddy grabs the mongoose’s tail, it won’t run into the house.
- C Unless they put it in a cage, the mongoose will run away.
- D The mongoose will only stay for one day.
- E As long as Teddy is kind, the mongoose will be happy in the house.

11

Why did Rikki-tikki fluff up his fur on the veranda?

- A to dry it
- B to look bigger
- C to warm up
- D to enjoy the sunshine
- E to clean it

12

Which of the following is NOT true about what Rikki-tikki did that day?

- A He ate some meat.
- B He watched the lamps being lit.
- C He hurt his nose.
- D He burned his fur.
- E He watched Teddy's father writing.

13

Why was Rikki-tikki a 'restless companion'? (line 44)

- A He was afraid of the noises.
- B He was curious about the noises.
- C He was itchy.
- D He had never slept on a pillow.
- E He made too much noise.

14

"I don't like that," said Teddy's mother.' (line 47)

What didn't she like?

- A Rikki-tikki was dirty.
- B Rikki-tikki was hungry.
- C Rikki-tikki was on the bed.
- D Rikki-tikki was scratching.
- E Rikki-tikki was making a mess.

15

"Teddy's safer with that little beast than if he had a bloodhound to watch him." (lines 48–49)

Why did Teddy's father think Teddy was safe?

- A The mongoose would protect Teddy from snakes.
- B Mongooses hunt bloodhounds.
- C Snakes hunt mongooses.
- D Snakes would stay away from the room.
- E Teddy would wake up.

16

'But Teddy's mother wouldn't think of anything so awful.' (line 50)

What was so awful?

- A the idea of a bloodhound in the room
- B the idea of a mongoose sleeping on the bed
- C the idea of a mongoose guarding Teddy
- D the idea that Teddy needed protecting
- E the idea of a snake coming in

Now answer the following questions about the meanings of words as they are used in the passage.

17

Which of the following is closest in meaning to ‘draggled’? (line 13)

- A dirty
- B ragged
- C limp
- D scuffed
- E bruised

18

Which of the following is closest in meaning to ‘immensely’? (line 35)

- A huge
- B tasty
- C greatly
- D noisily
- E hungrily

Now answer these questions about words and phrases as they are used in the passage.

19

‘...Chuchundra, the musk-rat, who never comes out into the middle of the floor, but always creeps round by the wall, gave him advice, but Rikki-tikki did the real fighting.’ (lines 3–4)

Which of the following does not appear in this sentence?

- A a proper noun
- B an adverb
- C a conjunction
- D a pronoun
- E a fronted adverbial

20

‘They gave him a little piece of raw meat. Rikki-tikki liked it immensely, and when it was finished he went out into the veranda and sat in the sunshine and fluffed up his fur to make it dry to the roots.’ (lines 35–37)

How many adverbs are there in this sentence?

- A one
- B two
- C three
- D four
- E five

In this exercise, you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that it makes sense and is written in correct English. Choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

Grammar Exercise

21 Had the moon not been so bright, I

would

should

had

did

will

A

B

C

D

E

not have seen the boulder in time.

22 Carl hated fish fingers. '

Past

Passed

Passing

Pass

Passes

 the ketchup,'

A

B

C

D

E

he grunted.

23 It could have fitted inside a matchbox, but that scorpion was the

scary

scariest

scarier

scared

scaring

 thing she had seen on the island.

A

B

C

D

E

24 'Give that tablet to me. It's not

you

her

she

he's

yours

 !'

A

B

C

D

E

25 The faster he ran, the

hardly

harder

hard

hardest

harden

 Max's

A

B

C

D

E

heart pounded.

26 Silent as a mouse, Maya leant her bike

under

in

behind

above

against

 the wall.

A

B

C

D

E

27 Olly plunged into the

icy	iced	icily	icer	ice
-----	------	-------	------	-----

 water and felt the
A B C D E
breath explode out of his lungs.

28 The starting gun fires and we

sprinted	sprint	will sprint	had sprinted	were sprinting
----------	--------	-------------	--------------	----------------

 out of the blocks.
A B C D E

29 It had been nearly five years, and

although	though	yet	however	but
----------	--------	-----	---------	-----

A B C D E
every detail of the house was clear in her memory.

30 'Yeah, right! If you're

the	a	an	that	this
-----	---	----	------	------

 astronaut then I'm the
A B C D E
Queen of England!'

31 On and on he played,

he's	her	hers	his	my
------	-----	------	-----	----

 fingers dancing over
A B C D E
the keys in a blur.

32 Aware of the danger, we decided to keep going

until	unless	up to	then	so
-------	--------	-------	------	----

 it got dark.
A B C D E

This exercise contains some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line, there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. **If there is no mistake, mark N.**

The Competition

33 It was the final of the anual singing competition in Dunston Community Hall. Pupils from
A B C D

34 most schools in the area had participated in the auditions. Now just two girls remaned.
A B C D

35 Carla waited nervously backstage. She glanced accross at Anita, who was bound to win –
A B C D

36 after all, she was last year's champion! Mrs Malik opened the door and announced that
A B C D

37 a decision had been made. The finalists needed to return to the stage imediately.
A B C D

38 Butterflys did back-flips in Carla's stomach as she walked out on stage again.
A B C D

39 The lighting seemed even more dazling than it had when she was performing.
A B C D

40 Carla wandered if this was how performers always felt. Even Anita looked nervous now.
A B C D

41 She willed herself to calm down. After all, she'd already done the hard part. .

A B C D

42 Carla surveyed the audience and took a deep breath to steady her nerves. Suddenly,

A B C D

43 there was a deafening round of applause as Carla was declared the winner and

A B C D

44 presented with an enormous certificate. It was amazing; she had actually won!

A B C D

In this exercise there are some mistakes in the use of capital letters and **punctuation**. On each numbered line, there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. **If there is no mistake, mark N.**

Pizzas All Round!

Maureen Maddison was 100 years old today!

45 Maureen didn't normally celebrate her birthday parties were for much younger people.
A B C D

46 However her grandchildren had insisted that becoming 100 could not be ignored. Everyone
A B C D

47 struggled to agree on the festivities. Dave suggested a fancy meal, Charlie proposed a
A B C D

48 huge party for family, friends and neighbours, and Maisie's choice was a weekend by the sea
A B C D

49 Eventually, everyone (even Charlie) agreed upon a quiet family meal at a local italian restaurant.
A B C D

50 'Yum! said Maureen. 'Everyone loves Italian food!'
A B C D

51 'Yeah, even Charlie' said Maisie. 'He's such a fussy eater.'
A B C D

52 Charlie rolled his eyes and groaned. 'You're never going to let me forget that, are you'



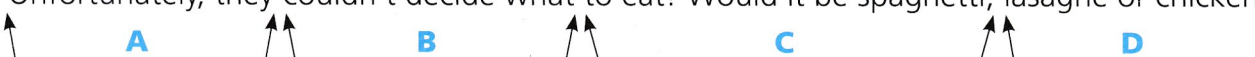
53 The big day arrived and everyone was excited. even Charlie looked happy.



54 Maureens' family gathered around a huge, circular table and pondered over the long menu.



55 Unfortunately, they couldn't decide what to eat! Would it be spaghetti, lasagne or chicken.



56 At last, Maureen took charge. 'Lets make it pizzas all round!' she said to the waiter.



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